

Self-Initiated Strategic Case Study

Not Worth The Trip

A quick-commerce campaign concept for Zepto.

SAGAR GAIKWAD - MARKETING STRATEGIST

2026 PUBLIC-DATA RESEARCH PROJECT. NOT COMMISSIONED CLIENT WORK.



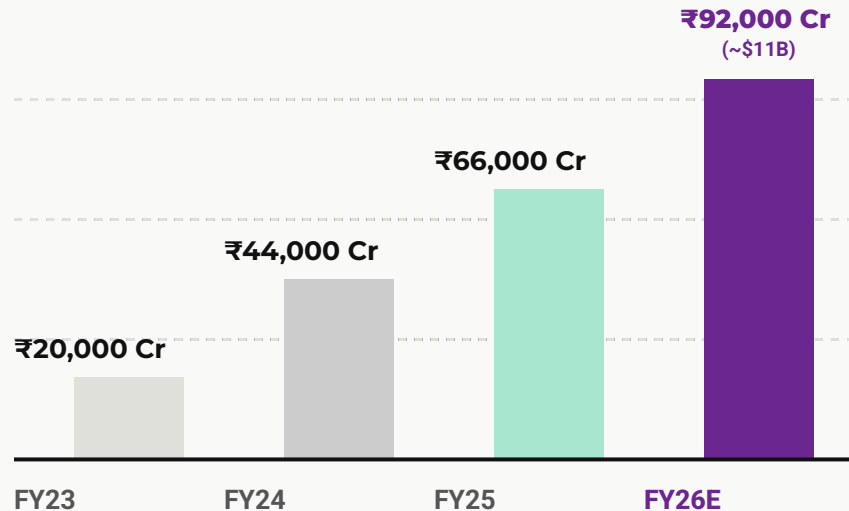
THE ₹92,000 CR MARKET RESET

Quick commerce has moved beyond emergency shopping into everyday urban retail.

DOMINANT MARKET SCALE

₹92K
Cr

Quick commerce has moved from an experimental convenience format into a scaled urban retail behaviour.



Source: Kotak Institutional Equities, reported 2026.

BEYOND THE 10-MINUTE DEFAULT

When speed becomes expected, it becomes harder to own as a distinctive brand idea.

74%

of surveyed consumers support removing the 10-minute promise.

When extreme speed is no longer universally necessary, the brand has room to sell a different kind of convenience.

38%

say they do not require 10-minute delivery for everyday goods.

For standard household restocks and non-emergency products, consumers value product availability and price transparency over extreme, immediate delivery speed.

90,000+ responses across 180 urban districts.

Source: LocalCircles, Quick Commerce Consumer Survey, Jan 2026.

THE CREATIVE LANDSCAPE

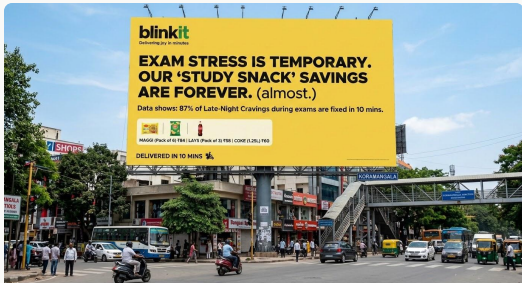
Different brands are fast. But they communicate that speed very differently.

Blinkit

Context + Data + Sharp Copy

Turns current events, real-world situations, or hyper-local consumer moments into short, highly contextual copy.

“Context becomes the headline.”



The category is fast. The creative differentiation is in how each brand uses that speed.

Swiggy Instamart

Entertainment + Convenience

Uses physical spectacle, grand scale, and unexpected category expansions to make ordering feel more engaging.

“Convenience becomes entertainment.”



Zepto

Culture + Agility

Responds in real-time to internet trends, customer feedback, and regional festivals with swift, playful creative executions.

“Culture becomes the opportunity.”



CREATIVE AUDIT – MY INTERPRETATION

URBAN REALITY: THE COST OF A SMALL TRIP

Traffic, parking, distance and everyday urban effort can make a simple shopping trip feel bigger than the need itself.



MUMBAI

Traffic · Parking · Local travel

Severe peak road congestion and high vehicle density turn basic physical transit into a persistent daily friction.



DELHI-NCR

Traffic · Parking · Heat

Extreme summer heat across Delhi-NCR can make even a short trip feel costly.

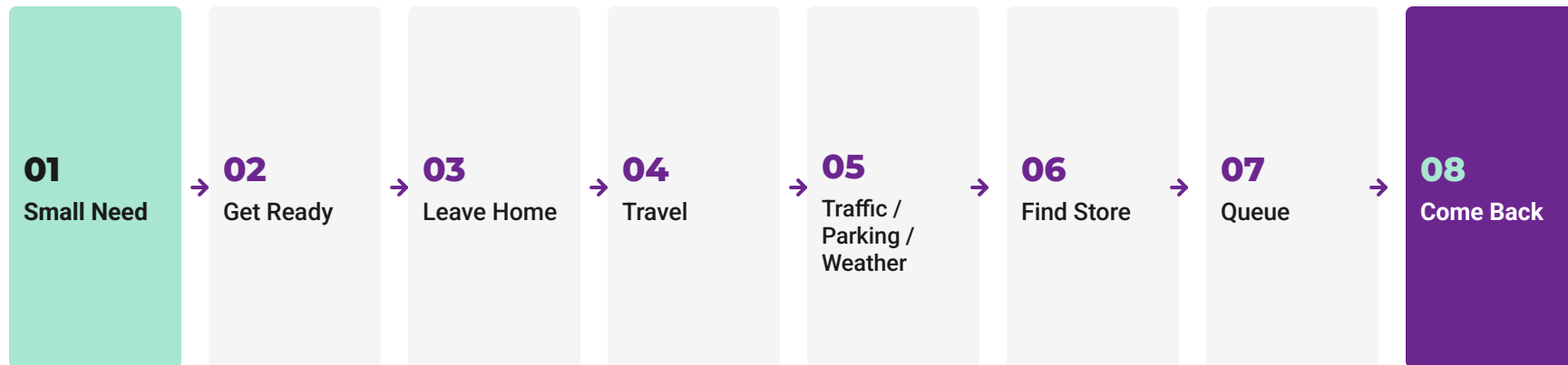
STRATEGIC CONTEXT — A small shopping need can sometimes come with a surprisingly large journey.

URBAN CONGESTION AUDIT (2025)

THE SMALLER THE NEED, THE STRANGER THE JOURNEY.

One missing item. A surprisingly long trip.

Process Diagram: The Disproportionate Journey



“When the journey feels bigger than the need, convenience becomes the smarter choice.”

STRATEGIC INTERPRETATION

SMART CONVENIENCE, NOT LAZINESS.

The idea works only if the reason to stay feels smarter than the excuse to stay.

Strategic ambition: *Make Zepto feel like the smarter choice when the trip is bigger than the need.*

THE RISK

"Just being lazy."

Passive Avoidance

The consumer excuse is passive: "I don't want to go." This framing makes quick-commerce feel like an enabler of pure inertia.

THE STRATEGIC RE-FRAME

LAZINESS



UNNECESSARY EFFORT



SMART CONVENIENCE

THE STRONGER READING

Smart friction avoidance.

Rational Choice

A small immediate need shouldn't require a giant, disproportionate journey. Staying in becomes the objective, logical decision.

"We're not giving people an excuse to stay home. We're giving them a reason they don't need to leave."

YOU DON'T NEED TO MAKE THE TRIP.

Zepto's value isn't just delivering fast.

It can make an unnecessary trip disappear.



What Could Zepto Own?

Not just the delivery. The decision that the trip isn't worth making.

1. The Trigger

Small Need

A single missing ingredient, a sudden craving, or a forgotten daily essential.



2. The Payoff

NO TRIP.

The trip disappears. The need doesn't.

WHO WE'RE SOLVING FOR?

Urban consumers with a small immediate need — and a disproportionately inconvenient trip ahead.

Strategic Opportunity: Celebrate the trips people are happy to skip.

The Big Idea

NOT WORTH THE TRIP.

Make the small need easier than making the trip.

Self-Initiated Concept

NOT WORTH THE TRIP



SOMETIMES, A SINGLE REASON IS ENOUGH.
STAY HOME. SHOP ONLINE.

THE CREATIVE SYSTEM

One idea. Many everyday situations.



TINY NEED

One small item

+



URBAN FRICTION

Heat, rain, traffic, queues



NOT WORTH THE TRIP

EXECUTION 01

One Small Cold Drink

Summer heat & no parking

→ Delhi-NCR / Hindi

EXECUTION 02

One Missing Ingredient

Monsoon rain & auto refusals

→ Mumbai / Marathi

SYSTEM LOCALISATION: MUMBAI / MARATHI • DELHI-NCR / HINDI

MUMBAI / MARATHI

A tiny missing ingredient can create a very unnecessary trip.



DELHI-NCR / HINDI

Avoiding a 46°C summer trip or Gurgaon parking nightmare for a single item.



ACTIVATION: REAL STORIES

01 / Real Frustration

**“Small need. Big hassle.
Tell us yours.”**

What was your Not-Worth-The-Trip?

Submit Story



02 / Zepto Content

**The audience supplies the situations.
Zepto supplies the solution.**

EXAMPLE SUBMISSION

**"Avoiding a Gurgaon parking nightmare
for one single item?"**

NOT WORTH THE TRIP.

zepto

MEASURE WHAT CHANGES, NOT JUST WHAT GETS SEEN.

01

ATTENTION

- Reach
- Video views



02

RESPONSE

- Engagement
- UGC submissions
- Social mentions



03

ACTION

- Brand search
- App visits / new users
- Not Worth The Trip” brand association

“Success means moving people from seeing the idea to acting on it.”

FROM EVIDENCE TO IDEA

01 / EVIDENCE

RESEARCH

Category, market and urban context

02 / PATTERN

AUDIT

Competitors + Zepto's creative behaviour

03 / THE CRUX

TENSION

*"Small need.
Disproportionate journey."*

Where research transforms into a human problem.

04 / THE LEAP

CAMPAIGN IDEA

**"NOT
WORTH THE
TRIP."**

05 / EXECUTION

LOCAL

- Mumbai / Marathi
- Delhi-NCR / Hindi

"Every creative decision came after the evidence."

RESEARCH SOURCES

Selected sources used to build the strategic case.

01 — MARKET & CATEGORY

Redseer

Quick Commerce: India's Retail Darling or Profit Mirage, July 2025.

02 — CONSUMER RESEARCH

Primary Consumer Research Audit (2025)

LocalCircles — Quick Commerce Consumer Survey, Jan 2026.

03 — SHOPPER / CONSUMER SIGNALS

NIQ Shopper Trends (2025)

Shopping behaviour and consumer context.

04 — URBAN CONTEXT

TomTom Traffic Index

TomTom Traffic Index — 2025 Mumbai / India traffic data.

05 — BRAND / COMPETITIVE EVIDENCE

Brand Campaign Audits

Official brand channels + campaign examples audited for Blinkit, Zepto and Swiggy Instamart.

ORIGINAL CREATIVE WORK

“Not Worth The Trip” — Self-initiated strategic and creative concept by **Sagar Gaikwad**.

The research and evidence are sourced. The campaign idea, copy, OOH concepts and creative executions are original portfolio work.